CHAPTER 1

GLORY

Someone else should bat.

It is Sunday, 18 January 2015. South Africa are playing a one-day international at the Wanderers Stadium in Johannesburg and a capacity crowd is enjoying the warm sunshine. Sent in to bat, openers Hashim Amla and Rilee Rossouw are playing brilliantly, building the ideal platform for a winning total.

In the changing room, as our score passes 200 without loss, I approach Russell Domingo, our coach.

'Let Dave Miller go in next, coach,' I say. 'This is perfect for him.'

'No, Abbas, you're next,' he replies, firmly.

That doesn't make sense. Sulieman Benn still has two overs to bowl and, if somebody gets out, Miller should go in and have a full go at the left-arm spinner who typically turns the ball in to the left-hander. The situation is made for him. We're 1–0 up in the five-match series, and we're expected to win, but we need to take every opportunity.

Amla and Rossouw are still going well, dominating, taking the score past 220. It's worth another try.

'Coach, I'm serious. Dave should go next.'

'No, you're the best man for this situation.'

The scoreboard keeps moving as Hash strokes another boundary through extra cover.